

The parts of a plant

FLOWERING PLANTS ARE BUSY 24 hours a day. During the daytime, their leaves collect the energy in sunlight so that they can make the food that they need to grow (pp. 14–15). To do this, plants also need water and minerals, which their roots collect from the soil. Once the Sun sets, a plant cannot make food any more. Instead, it concentrates on using its food and on moving it to where it is needed most. To do all these things, a plant uses special cells that connect its roots, stems, and leaves. These cells work like microscopic pipes, and they carry everything that a plant needs. As long as they work, the plant will thrive, but if they get damaged the plant may wither or die.

